

SHE'S THE VIBE

Healing Vibe

INNER CHILD · BOUNDARIES · SELF-TRUST

a guided journal

This journal belongs to



A private space for honest reflection, unfinished thoughts, and becoming.

NAME

Use any name that feels like yours.

WHAT I WANT THIS SPACE TO FEEL LIKE

Examples: gentle, private, brave, playful, clear, unhurried.

A PROMISE I CAN REALISTICALLY MAKE TO MYSELF

Try something smaller than perfection: I will notice when I need to pause.

PRIVACY MATTERS

Store this journal where it feels safe. If another person monitors your device, accounts, or belongings, use the format and location that protect you best.

Welcome to Healing Vibe



This is not a race back to who you were. It is a place to meet who you are with honesty and care.

WHAT THIS JOURNAL IS

A guided reflection space for noticing patterns, honoring younger parts of you, practicing boundaries, regulating overwhelm, rebuilding self-trust, and making room for joy.

WHAT THIS JOURNAL IS NOT

It is not therapy, diagnosis, a memory-recovery method, or a demand to forgive, reconcile, disclose, or contact anyone. You are allowed to skip any page.

THE CENTRAL PERMISSION

Go slowly enough to stay with yourself. A blank page can mean wisdom. A pause can be progress. A boundary can be love directed inward.

WHAT BRINGS ME HERE

One sentence is enough.

Before you begin



Use this book alongside qualified support when the material is bigger than a journal can safely hold.

YOUR SAFETY COMES FIRST

Stop if you feel flooded, numb, disoriented, unsafe, or unable to return to the present. Move toward light, water, food, rest, a trusted person, professional support, or emergency help as needed.

MEMORY DESERVES CARE

Prompts use phrases such as 'what I remember' and 'what I am unsure about.' The journal will not ask you to force certainty, recover memories, or assign a diagnosis to another person.

CHOICE STAYS WITH YOU

Forgiveness is not required. Reconciliation is not required. Contact is not required. You can understand a person and still limit their access to you.

MY SIGNS THAT IT IS TIME TO PAUSE

Body sensations, thoughts, behaviors, or changes in attention.

Choose your path



You do not have to read front to back. Start where your capacity and curiosity meet.

☐ Understand a pattern

Begin at ROOTS, then PATTERNS.

☐ Practice a boundary

Go to BOUNDARIES and FINDING YOUR VOICE.

☐ Reconnect with younger you

Use YOUNGER YOU and move slowly.

☐ Calm overload

Go to SELF-TRUST + REGULATION.

☐ Think about relationships

Use RELATIONSHIPS; skip names if privacy matters.

☐ Need something light

Go directly to JOY + PLAY.

YOU CAN CHANGE PATHS

Circle back, jump ahead, repeat a grounding page, or close the book. The journal works for you - not the other way around.

Know the page signals



A small symbol in each header helps you choose a page that fits your present capacity.



SUN - LIGHT + CREATIVE

Playful, future-facing, artistic, or lower-intensity reflection.



CLOUD - REFLECTIVE

Meaningful reflection that may bring emotion without centering the hardest material.



STORM - GO GENTLY

Potentially activating material. A Soft Landing panel is included.



ANCHOR - GROUND + SUPPORT

Regulation, orientation, support planning, and practical care.

A SIGNAL IS AN INVITATION, NOT A WARNING LABEL

You decide what is light or heavy for you today. Capacity changes. That is information, not failure.

Capacity check-in



Before deeper reflection, notice what is true right now.

MY ENERGY TODAY

What is available - not what should be available.

WHAT IS TAKING UP SPACE

Name the loudest feeling, thought, demand, or sensation.

WHAT WOULD MAKE THIS SESSION SAFER OR GENTLER

Light, music, privacy, water, a time limit, a support person, or choosing a lighter page.

My immediate support plan



Complete this when you feel steady. Keep it easy to find.

A PERSON I CAN CONTACT

Name + safest way to reach them.

A PLACE WHERE I FEEL SAFER

A room, public place, neighbor, community space, or care setting.

WHAT HELPS ME RETURN TO THE PRESENT

Specific sounds, objects, movements, words, faith practices, or sensory supports.

PROFESSIONAL OR CRISIS SUPPORT

Provider, local line, national resource, urgent care, emergency service.

IMMEDIATE DANGER

If you or someone else is in immediate danger, contact local emergency services. U.S. readers can call or text 988 for crisis support; international readers should add local numbers on the resources page.

A grounding menu

Choose one or two options. More is not automatically better.



RETURN THROUGH SENSES

- ☐ Name five neutral things you see
- ☐ Hold something cool or textured
- ☐ Notice one steady sound
- ☐ Sip water slowly
- ☐ Look for three rectangles

RETURN THROUGH ACTION

- ☐ Press both feet into the floor
- ☐ Change rooms or face a window
- ☐ Loosen tight clothing
- ☐ Say today's date and location
- ☐ Text a safe person

WHAT TENDS TO WORK FOR ME

Keep your own short list; cross out anything that does not help.

Contents



Part one

12**ROOTS**

Early messages, roles, needs, and belonging

24**PATTERNS**

Triggers, reactions, coping, and cycles

36**YOUNGER YOU**

Age-specific reflection, letters, and reparenting

48**GRIEF + ANGER**

Loss, unfairness, anger, and closure without contact

60**BOUNDARIES**

Limits, scripts, access, consequences, and voice

NAVIGATION TIP

PDF bookmarks jump to each major section. Divider pages are also designed as printable tab pages.

Contents



Part two

73**SELF-TRUST + REGULATION**

Overstimulation, decompression, coping, and intuition

88**RELATIONSHIPS**

Safety, reciprocity, repair, receiving care

100**JOY + PLAY**

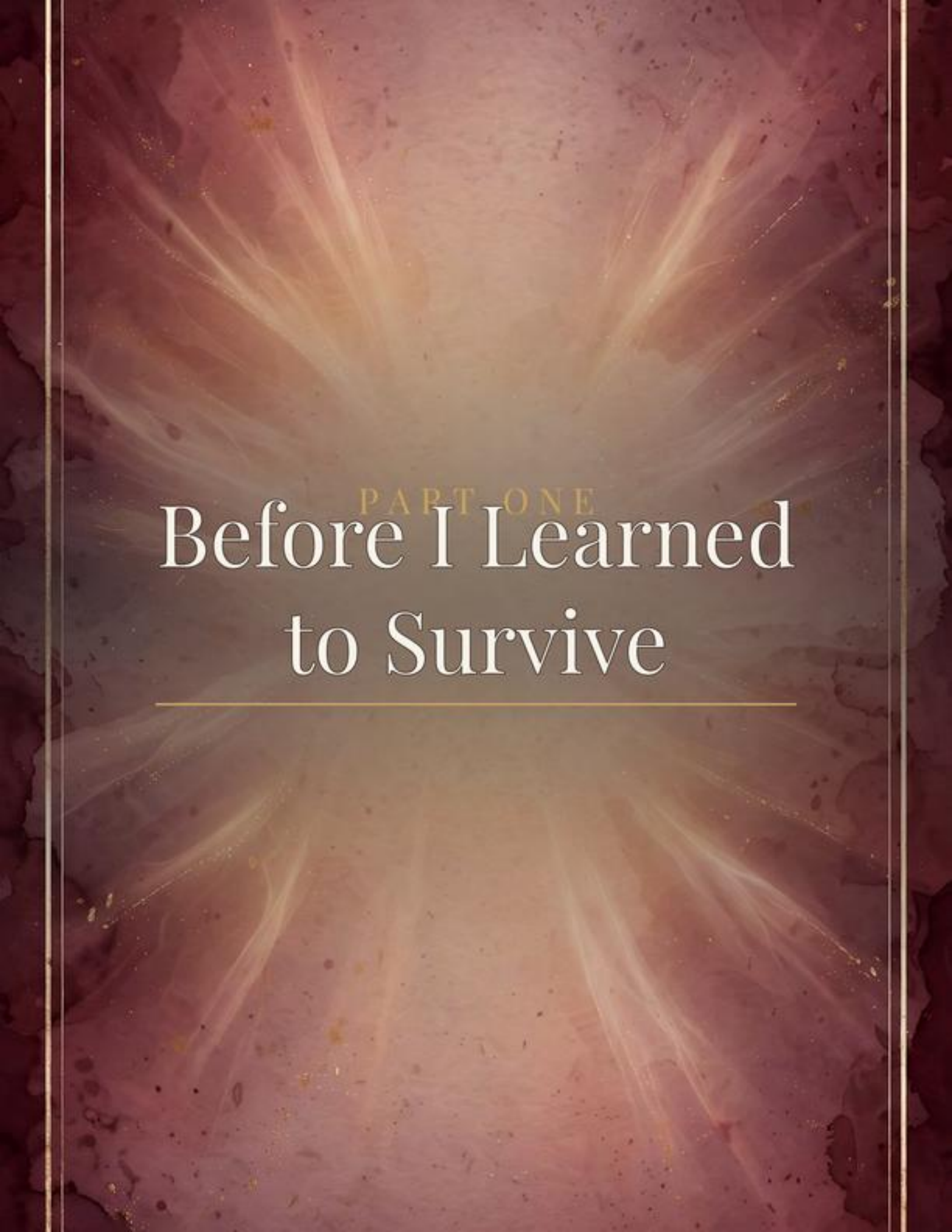
Creativity, pleasure, curiosity, and self-discovery

111**CHOOSE NOW**

Values, future, support, and next steps

WHERE I WANT TO BEGIN

Page, section, or intention.



PART ONE

Before I Learned to Survive

What I remember

Hold memory with humility. Fragments, sensations, and uncertainty may all belong on the page.



A GENTLER FRAME

The goal is not a perfect record. The goal is to notice what you carry now without forcing certainty.

WHAT I REMEMBER CLEARLY

People, places, routines, moments, or feelings.

WHAT I AM UNSURE ABOUT

Leave room for not knowing. You do not need to fill gaps.

WHAT MEANING I MADE THEN

What did younger you conclude about self, love, safety, or belonging?

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

The emotional weather at home

Describe the climate, not a verdict on the people in it.



WHAT COULD BE FELT OPENLY

Which emotions were welcomed, ignored, punished, mocked, or made dangerous?

WHAT EVERYONE LEARNED TO TRACK

Mood shifts, tone, footsteps, silence, expectations, conflict, or unpredictability.

HOW I ADAPTED

What helped you belong, avoid harm, gain approval, or keep peace?

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Messages I absorbed

Some lessons were spoken. Others were learned from what repeatedly happened.



MESSAGES ABOUT ME

- ☐ My needs are too much
- ☐ I must earn love
- ☐ I should stay small
- ☐ Mistakes make me unsafe
- ☐ My feelings inconvenience others

MESSAGES I WANT NOW

- ☐ Needs carry information
- ☐ Love is not a performance prize
- ☐ I can take up humane space
- ☐ Mistakes can include repair
- ☐ Feelings can be respected

A MESSAGE I AM READY TO QUESTION

Write the old rule, where it may have come from, and a truer alternative.

The roles I learned to play

A role can be intelligent survival - and still become exhausting.



THE ROLE

Peacekeeper, achiever, invisible one, caretaker, entertainer, rebel, scapegoat, translator, or another role.

WHAT THE ROLE PROTECTED

What did it help you avoid, receive, predict, or control?

WHAT IT COSTS NOW

Energy, honesty, intimacy, rest, choice, or a clear sense of self.

What I needed someone to notice

Needs are not accusations. They are part of being human.



WHAT WAS HAPPENING

Use only the amount of detail that feels useful.

WHAT I NEEDED

Protection, comfort, explanation, play, consistency, belief, advocacy, privacy, or presence.

HOW THAT NEED SHOWS UP TODAY

In relationships, work, faith, rest, conflict, parenting, or self-talk.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Belonging and difference

Identity may include culture, race, faith, class, disability, adoption, estrangement, migration, gender, sexuality, or chosen family.



WHERE I FELT SEEN

Who or what reflected me back with warmth and accuracy?

WHERE I LEARNED TO EDIT MYSELF

What parts felt safer to hide, soften, translate, or over-explain?

WHAT BELONGING MEANS TO ME NOW

Describe the conditions, not only the people.

Faith, meaning, and the questions I carry

You are allowed to love God, hold questions, grieve spiritual harm, and seek communities that make room for your full humanity.



WHAT HAS SUSTAINED ME

Prayer, scripture, ritual, community, nature, ancestors, music, service, mystery, or something else.

WHAT HAS BEEN COMPLICATED OR PAINFUL

Distinguish the sacred from what people may have done in its name.

WHAT I WANT MY SPIRITUAL LIFE TO FEEL LIKE

Words such as honest, loving, spacious, accountable, rooted, free, or protected.

What was mine - and what was not

Separate responsibility from burdens a child could not reasonably carry.



MINE TO HONOR

- ☐ My feelings
- ☐ My preferences
- ☐ My questions
- ☐ My need for care
- ☐ My developing identity

NOT MINE TO CARRY

- ☐ An adult's emotional regulation
- ☐ Keeping the family image
- ☐ Preventing every conflict
- ☐ Earning basic care
- ☐ Explaining another person's harm

A BURDEN I AM SETTING DOWN

What changes when this responsibility returns to its rightful owner?

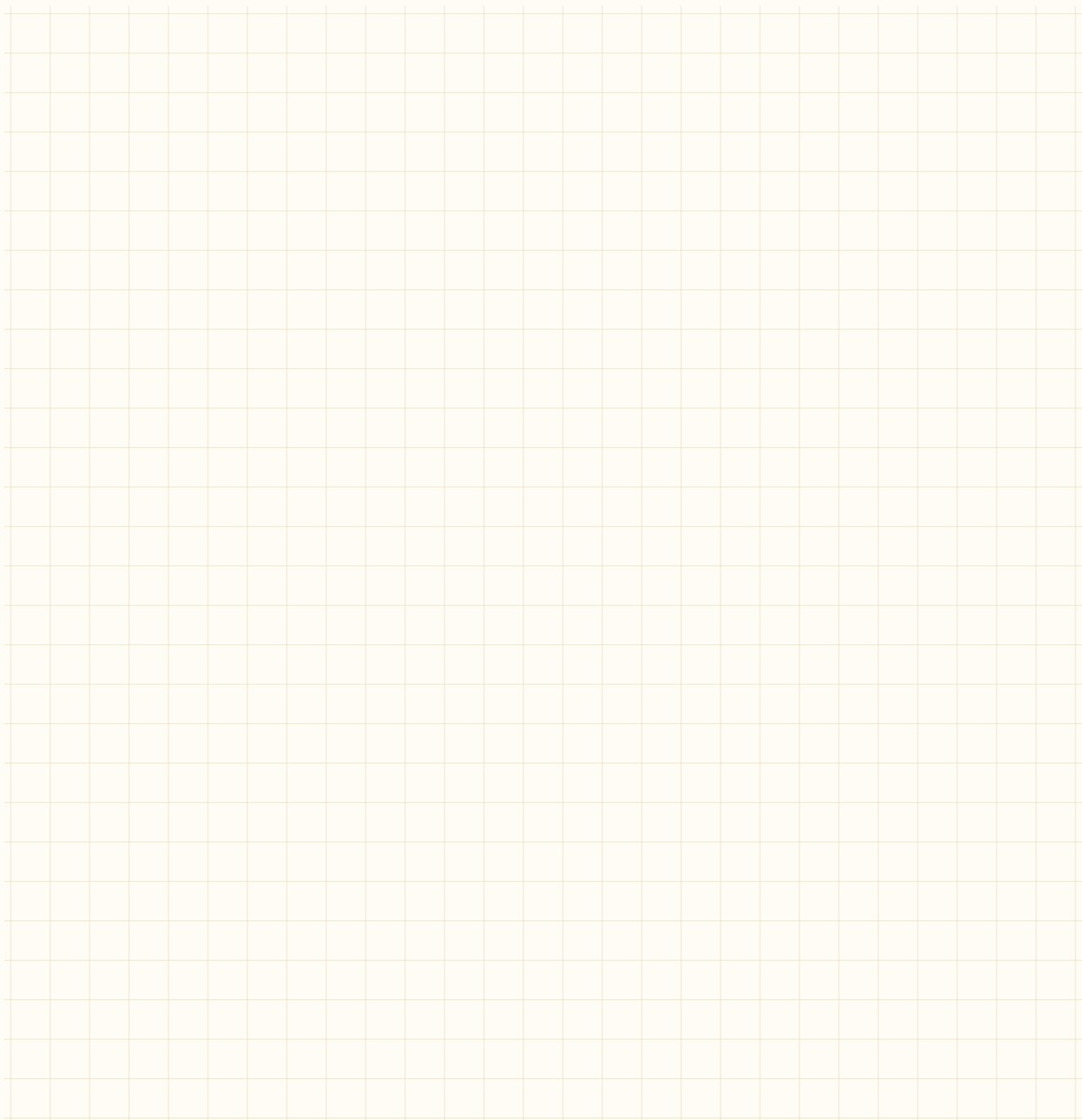
A map of the places that shaped me

Draw rooms, homes, neighborhoods, schools, faith spaces, landscapes, or imaginary places that mattered.



MAKE IT YOURS

Use symbols or colors for comfort, tension, freedom, belonging, secrecy, and change. Accuracy is optional; meaning is the point.



What I learned about rest

Rest may have been safe, earned, interrupted, mocked, or unavailable.



THE OLD RULE ABOUT REST

Finish: Rest was allowed when...

HOW MY BODY REACTS TO SLOWING DOWN

Calm, guilt, vigilance, boredom, grief, racing thoughts, relief, or something else.

A KINDER RULE I AM PRACTICING

Make it believable, not perfect.

One-minute arrival

A brief transition into reflection.



1

Look around and name where you are, the date, and the time of day.

2

Feel one point of contact: feet, seat, back, or hands. No need to relax it.

3

Notice one neutral color and one ordinary sound.

4

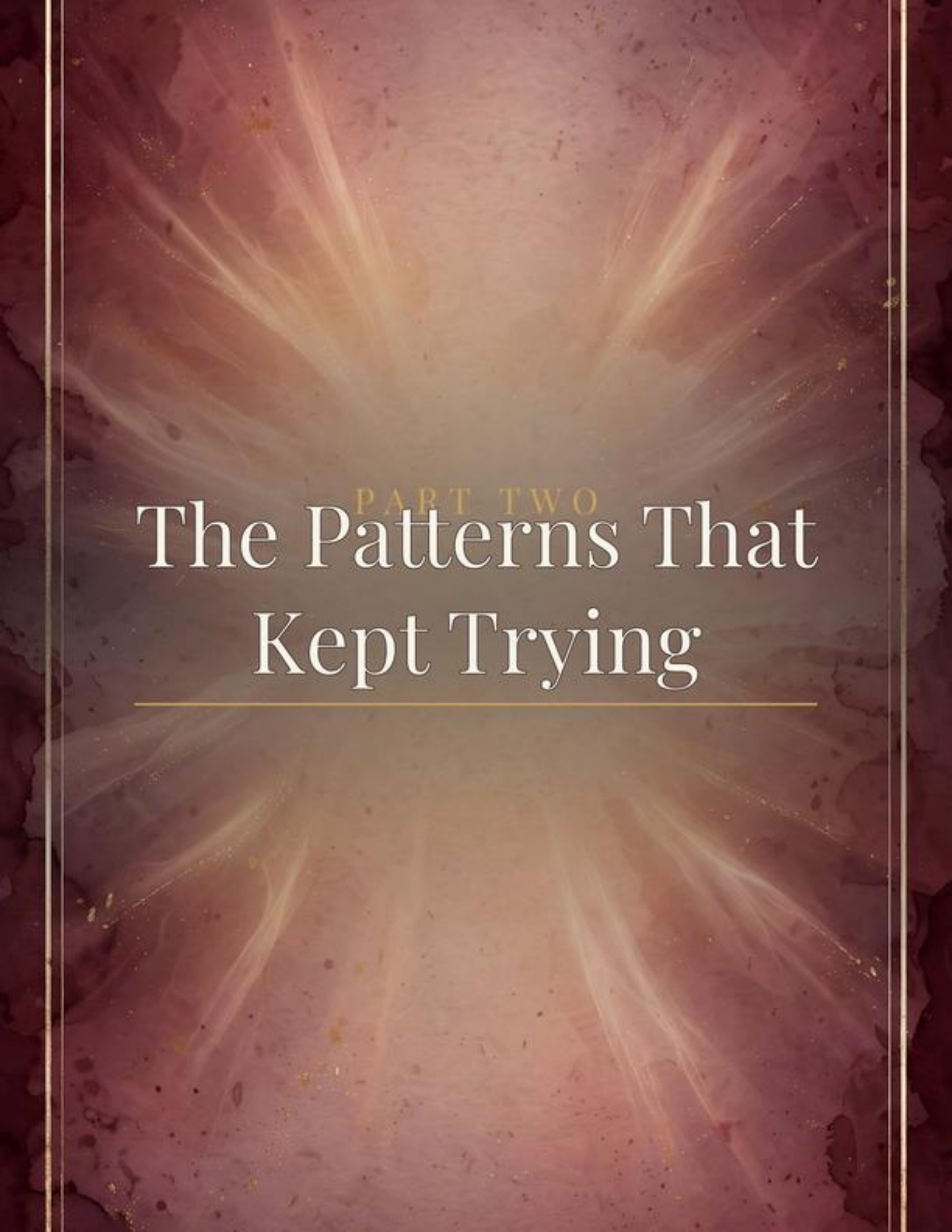
Ask: What amount of reflection is kind today? Choose a time limit.

5

Say: I can pause before I have an explanation. Then begin - or choose not to.

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.



PART TWO

The Patterns That Kept Trying

A pattern I keep meeting



Describe one repeatable sequence. Start small and specific.

WHAT TENDS TO HAPPEN FIRST

Situation, request, tone, silence, expectation, or internal thought.

WHAT I FEEL AND DO NEXT

Include body, emotion, thought, urge, and action if useful.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTERWARD

Short-term relief, longer-term cost, repair, avoidance, resentment, or confusion.

Trigger - story - response



A trigger is not proof of danger; it is a cue to investigate what your system expects.

THE TRIGGER

What actually happened, in observable words?

THE STORY MY MIND SUPPLIED

What did you fear it meant?

WHAT I DID - AND WHAT I NEEDED

Separate the response from the underlying need.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

My protection responses



These are possibilities, not diagnoses. Check only what feels familiar.

OUTWARD OR ACTIVE

- ☐ Argue or push harder
- ☐ Leave or stay busy
- ☐ Fix everything immediately
- ☐ Over-explain
- ☐ Control details

INWARD OR ADAPTIVE

- ☐ Freeze or go blank
- ☐ Agree to stay safe
- ☐ Become very small
- ☐ Disconnect from needs
- ☐ Shut down afterward

WHAT EACH RESPONSE IS TRYING TO PROTECT

Respond with respect before deciding what you want to change.

The people-pleasing loop



Kindness and self-erasure are not the same thing.

WHAT I FEAR WILL HAPPEN IF I DISAPPOINT SOMEONE

Be specific about the feared consequence.

WHAT I AGREE TO AGAINST MYSELF

Time, labor, access, money, emotional caretaking, silence, or availability.

A SMALLER HONEST RESPONSE

Try delay, partial help, a question, or a clear no.

Perfectionism as protection



Perfectionism often promises safety, belonging, certainty, or exemption from criticism.

WHAT PERFECTION PROMISES ME

If I do this flawlessly, then...

WHAT IT DEMANDS

Time, sleep, risk avoidance, harsh self-talk, delay, or never finishing.

WHAT 'COMPLETE ENOUGH' LOOKS LIKE

Define an observable stopping point.

Meet the inner critic



Turn the critic from an all-powerful narrator into one voice you can answer.

THE CRITIC SAYS

Write the exact message without adding new insults.

THE PROTECTOR UNDERNEATH MIGHT FEAR

What danger, shame, rejection, or loss is it trying to prevent?

MY GROUNDED ADULT VOICE ANSWERS

Try firm and humane: I hear the fear. Cruelty is not required for growth.

THE NEXT WORKABLE ACTION IS

Choose one action small enough to do without self-attack.

Make the critic ridiculous



Turn a recurring critical phrase into an absurd cartoon character, overdramatic headline, tiny monster, bad infomercial, or weather alert.

MAKE IT YOURS

Humor does not deny pain. It changes your distance from a thought. Add a name, costume, catchphrase, and an off switch.



Coping without moral judgment



Instead of 'good' or 'bad,' ask what a strategy does, costs, and protects.

THE COPING STRATEGY

What do you reach for when things are heavy?

HOW IT HELPS NOW - AND LATER

Immediate relief, delayed impact, safety, cost, or secondary problem.

THE NEED UNDERNEATH

Relief, control, numbness, connection, rest, expression, protection, or predictability.

A GENTLER SUBSTITUTE OR COMPANION

Not punishment - another way to meet part of the same need.

The shame spiral



Shame says 'I am bad.' Accountability names what happened and what repair asks of me.

WHAT HAPPENED

Use concrete behavior instead of a global identity.

WHAT SHAME SAYS ABOUT ME

Write the sweeping conclusion.

WHAT ACCOUNTABILITY SAYS

Name impact, responsibility, repair, learning, and limits.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

A cycle I want to interrupt



Breaking a cycle is not proof you never repeat it. It is the practice of noticing sooner and repairing more honestly.

THE CYCLE

What repeats across time or relationships?

THE EARLIEST CHOICE POINT

Where is the smallest moment you may be able to pause or redirect?

WHAT SUPPORT MAKES CHANGE MORE LIKELY

People, structure, treatment, reminders, scripts, distance, rest, or practice.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Leaving it on the page



A closing practice after writing something heavy.

1

Stop writing. Place both hands somewhere neutral or look at two steady objects.

2

Say: This page holds words. I am here, in the present, and I choose what comes next.

3

Close or cover the page if that helps. You do not need to reread it now.

4

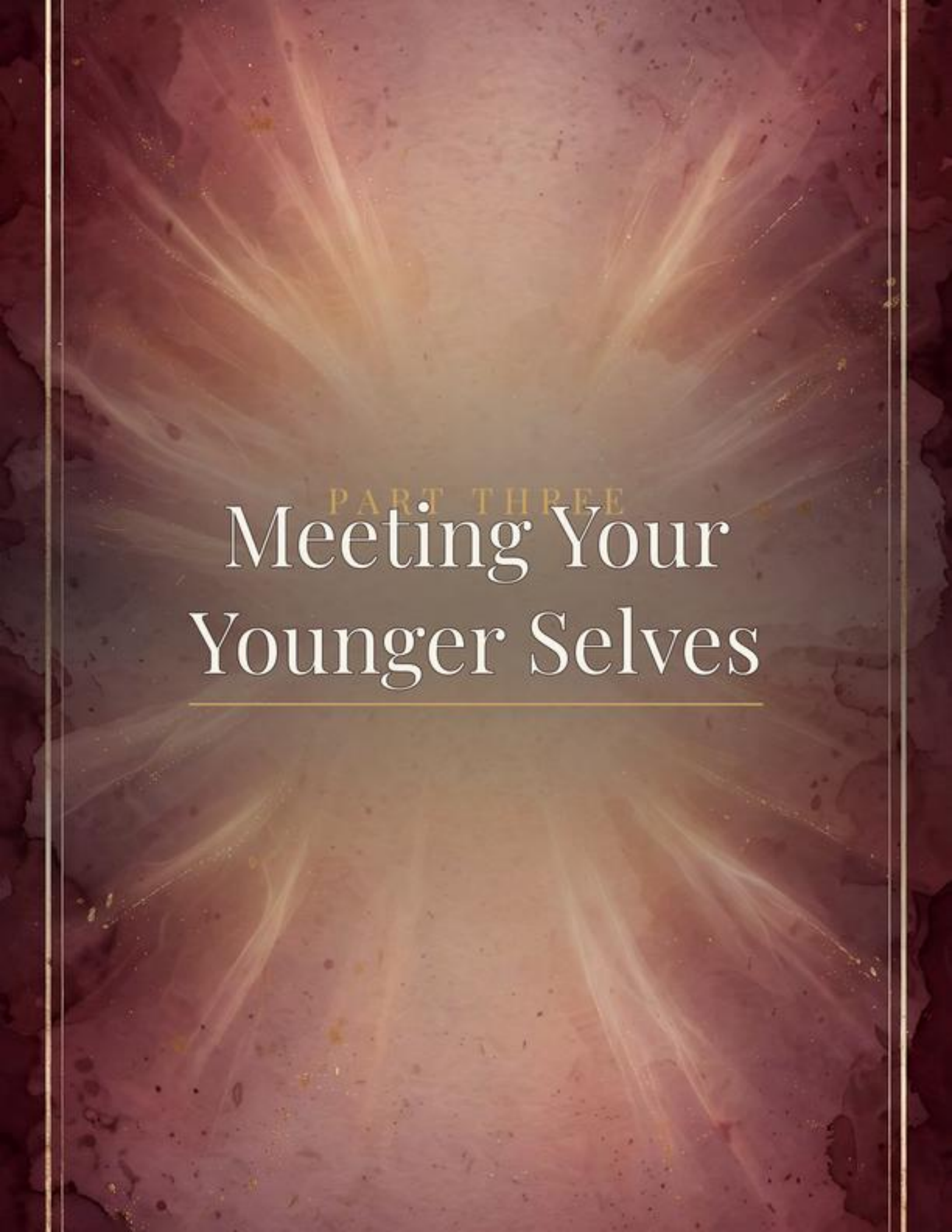
Name three tasks or ordinary facts waiting in the present day.

5

Choose one transition: wash hands, step outside, change music, eat, pray, stretch, or contact support.

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.



PART THREE

Meeting Your Younger Selves

Choose an age gently



Pick an age or season that feels available - not necessarily the hardest one.

THE AGE OR SEASON

A number, school year, home, relationship, or life chapter.

WHAT I NOTICE ABOUT THEM

Interests, posture, worries, strengths, clothes, dreams, habits, or expressions.

WHAT FEELS SAFE ENOUGH TO EXPLORE

Set a boundary for this session.

What they deserved to hear



Write to the younger you without forcing a feeling you do not have.

WHAT I BELIEVE THEM ABOUT

You may keep details private.

WHAT WAS NEVER THEIR JOB

Name burdens, secrets, roles, or outcomes.

THREE SENTENCES THEY DESERVED

Try: You make sense. I am listening. You do not have to earn care.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

A two-voice conversation



Let younger you speak; let present you answer without correcting or rushing.

YOUNGER ME SAYS

I wish you understood...

PRESENT ME RESPONDS

I am listening. What I want you to know is...

YOUNGER ME ASKS

What happens now? Who protects us?

PRESENT ME OFFERS

One truthful promise I can keep is...

Reparenting: protection



Reparenting here means reflective, practical self-care - not pretending the past can be rewritten.

WHAT PROTECTION MEANS NOW

Distance, locks, documentation, healthcare, privacy, advocacy, financial planning, a boundary, or asking for help.

WHERE I OVERRIDE MY OWN WARNING SIGNS

Notice without blaming yourself.

ONE PROTECTIVE ACTION I CAN TAKE

Make it concrete and within your control.

Reparenting: comfort



Comfort can be sensory, relational, spiritual, practical, or quietly ordinary.

WHAT COMFORT FELT LIKE THEN

Even if it was rare, imagined, or found outside home.

WHAT COMFORT FEELS LIKE NOW

Textures, foods, voices, prayer, routines, music, temperature, or privacy.

A COMFORT I CAN MAKE EASIER TO ACCESS

Prepare it before a hard day if possible.

WHAT DOES NOT COMFORT ME

Release the pressure to like common coping suggestions.

Reparenting: consistency



Trust grows through promises small enough to keep and repairs honest enough to matter.

A TINY PROMISE

Food, medicine, bedtime, a call, a five-minute task, or one clear boundary.

WHAT COULD GET IN THE WAY

Plan for capacity, resources, fear, executive function, or changing circumstances.

HOW I WILL REPAIR IF I MISS IT

No punishment. Name it, adjust it, and begin again.

Reparenting: play



Play does not have to be productive, social, photogenic, or good enough to share.

WHAT I LOVED BEFORE I CARED WHAT PEOPLE THOUGHT

Games, colors, stories, movement, collecting, making, pretending, exploring.

WHAT STILL SPARKS CURIOSITY

Small interest counts.

A TEN-MINUTE PLAY DATE WITH MYSELF

When, where, and what permission it needs.

The apology I deserved



This is an unsent exercise. You decide whether it is useful; nobody else has to see it.

WHAT NEEDED ACKNOWLEDGMENT

An honest apology names the behavior and impact without excuses.

WHAT ACCOUNTABILITY WOULD HAVE SOUNDED LIKE

Include responsibility, change, repair, and respect for your choice.

WHAT I CAN GIVE MYSELF WITHOUT RECEIVING IT

Validation, distance, grief, truth, support, ritual, or a new decision.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Design a safe-enough room



Draw, collage, list, or type a room for your younger self. Include exits, privacy, light, comfort, nourishment, play, and who is or is not allowed inside.

MAKE IT YOURS

Safe-enough is intentional: no imagined place must feel perfectly safe. Create choice, visibility, and control.

A compassionate meeting



Use this only if visualization feels supportive. External focus is always an option.

1

Orient to the room first. Keep your eyes open if you prefer. Feel one stable surface.

2

Imagine - or simply write about - a younger you at a comfortable distance. You control the distance.

3

Notice only what feels available. Do not search for details or memories.

4

Offer one phrase: I believe your feelings. You do not have to explain everything to me.

5

Ask whether they want comfort, protection, play, space, or nothing right now.

6

End the image. Name five present-day facts and choose a real-world act of care.

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.

A postcard across time



Write or draw a postcard from present you to younger you - or from younger you to present you.

MAKE IT YOURS

Keep it short. Include one truth, one image, and one invitation. It does not need to be sentimental.



PART FOUR

What Was Lost.
What Was Unfair.

The many shapes of loss



Loss may include a person, childhood, safety, time, health, community, belief, opportunity, identity, or imagined future.

WHAT I LOST

Name one loss without comparing it to anyone else's.

WHAT THAT LOSS CONTAINED

Routines, hopes, roles, protection, belonging, witness, possibility.

WHAT I MISS - AND WHAT I DO NOT MISS

Mixed feelings belong here.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Ambiguous loss



Some losses have no clear ending: estrangement, change, disappearance, illness, migration, or grieving someone who is still alive.

WHAT IS ABSENT

What relationship, role, capacity, certainty, or future is missing?

WHAT IS STILL PRESENT

Contact, memories, responsibilities, hope, love, fear, questions, or reminders.

WHAT CLOSURE CANNOT SOLVE

What may need ongoing care instead of a final answer?

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Anger is carrying information



Anger can point toward violation, grief, fear, exhaustion, injustice, or a crossed boundary.

WHAT ANGER WANTS ME TO NOTICE

What mattered enough to activate this response?

WHAT ANGER URGES ME TO DO

Separate the urge from the action you choose.

A SAFE EXPRESSION OR PROTECTIVE ACTION

Movement, words, art, advocacy, documentation, distance, or support.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

The unfairness page



You do not have to make meaning out of what should not have happened.

WHAT WAS UNFAIR

Say it plainly.

WHAT IT COST ME

Time, safety, choices, trust, health, money, innocence, ease, or connection.

WHAT I REFUSE TO BLAME MYSELF FOR

Return responsibility with clarity.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

The unsent letter



This page does not ask you to deliver, forgive, or reopen contact.

WHAT I NEED TO SAY

The unedited truth is...

WHAT I NEEDED FROM YOU

I needed protection / honesty / repair / respect / care...

WHAT I WILL NO LONGER CARRY

I return the responsibility for...

WHAT I CHOOSE NOW

Whether or not you understand, I choose...

Closure without contact



Closure can be a decision, boundary, ritual, witness, or ongoing practice - not a conversation another person must provide.

WHAT I WISH COULD BE RESOLVED

Name the question, apology, explanation, or outcome.

WHAT CONTACT MIGHT COST

Emotional, physical, practical, relational, digital, spiritual, or legal cost.

A FORM OF CLOSURE I CONTROL

A letter kept private, changed access, memorial, therapy, prayer, art, documentation, or new commitment.

Grief comes in waves



A wave does not mean you are back at the beginning.

WHAT TENDS TO BRING A WAVE

Dates, places, music, family events, body states, transitions, success, or quiet.

HOW A WAVE MOVES THROUGH ME

Duration, body sensations, thoughts, needs, and what changes its intensity.

WHAT I WANT AVAILABLE NEXT TIME

Food, rest, privacy, company, ritual, flexibility, or professional support.

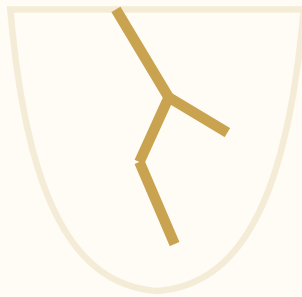
A vessel for what cannot be fixed



Draw or describe a vessel strong enough to hold grief without asking it to disappear.

MAKE IT YOURS

Add cracks, gold mending, weight, handles, a lid, openings, or witnesses. Label what belongs inside and what remains outside.



Grief can rest here

A practice of temporary containment, not denial.



1

Orient to the present room and choose a container: a page, box, bowl, shelf, or imagined place.

2

Name the grief in one short phrase. You do not need to explain its whole history.

3

Say: I am not abandoning this. I am choosing where it rests for now.

4

Imagine or physically place the phrase in the container. Set a time to return only if that feels helpful.

5

Move toward one ordinary act: wash a cup, feel the floor, open a curtain, eat, pray, or contact someone.

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.

A ritual that fits me



Ritual can be spiritual, cultural, private, communal, creative, or very simple.

WHAT I WANT TO HONOR

A person, version of self, lost hope, transition, or truth.

THE ELEMENTS

Words, objects, music, light, food, water, movement, prayer, silence, witness.

THE BOUNDARY AROUND IT

Privacy, time, location, safety, who may attend, what happens afterward.

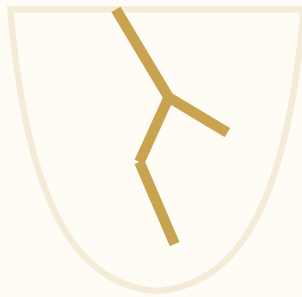
Color the feeling without naming it

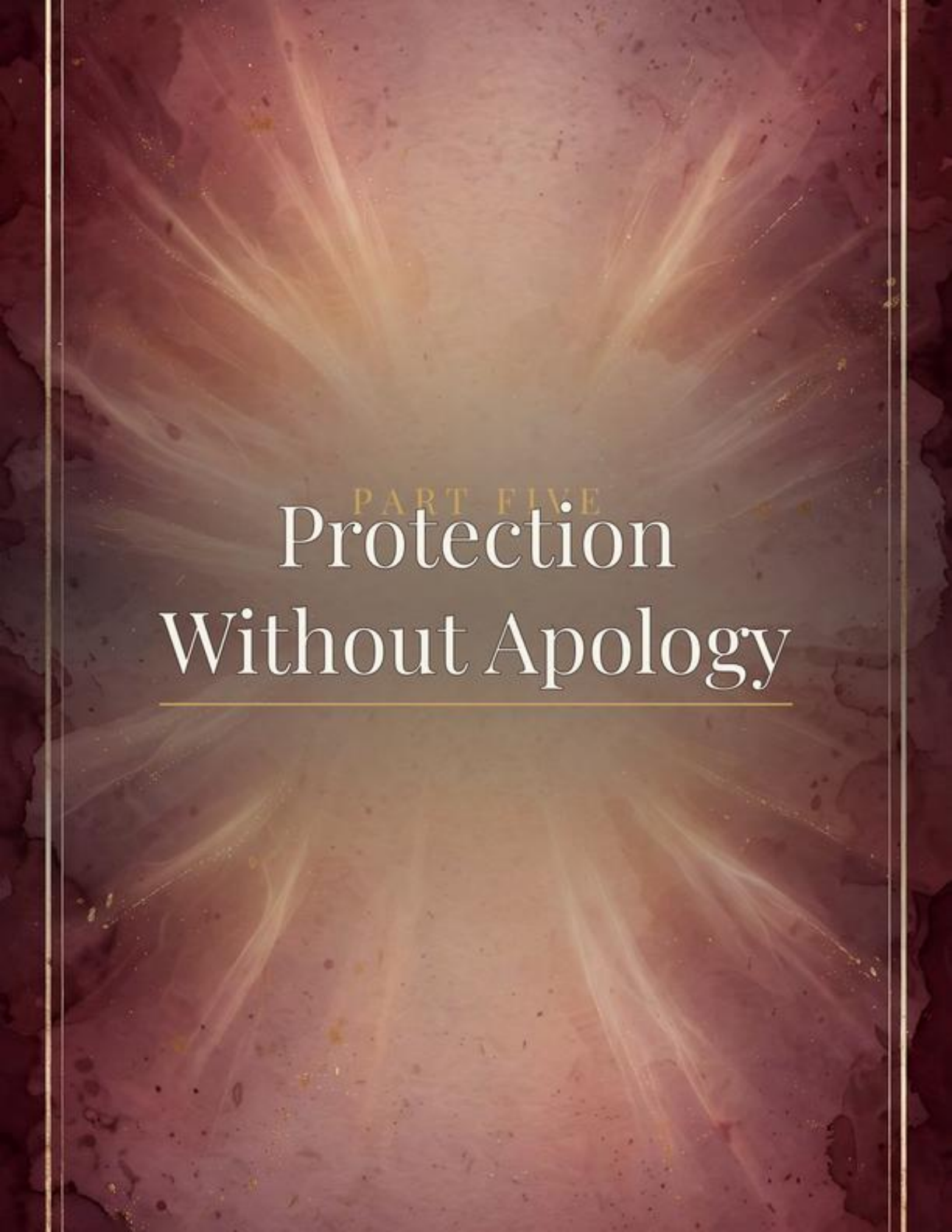
Use color, pressure, shape, texture, line, or typed marks. No explanation is required.



MAKE IT YOURS

Let the page hold intensity without turning it into a lesson. Stop whenever making marks stops helping.





PART FIVE

Protection Without Apology

What a boundary protects



Start with the value or need underneath the limit.

WHAT MATTERS HERE

Safety, rest, dignity, time, privacy, health, money, faith, attention, or trust.

WHAT IS HAPPENING NOW

Observable behavior, not a character diagnosis.

WHAT I WILL DO

State an action within your control.

Request, limit, consequence



Clarity improves when you know which kind of statement you are making.

A REQUEST ASKS

- ☐ Please lower your voice
- ☐ Can we reschedule?
- ☐ Please ask before sharing
- ☐ Would you text first?
- ☐ Can we pause this topic?

A BOUNDARY STATES

- ☐ I will leave if shouting starts
- ☐ I am unavailable tonight
- ☐ I do not share that information
- ☐ I answer when I can
- ☐ I will not discuss this topic

MY SITUATION IN BOTH FORMS

Write a request you may make and the boundary you control if the request is not respected.

Boundary scripts: time + access



Short is complete. You do not owe a courtroom defense.

DECLINING

I cannot take that on.

DELAYING

I need time to think. I will answer by...

LIMITING ACCESS

I am available for... I am not available for...

ENDING THE INTERACTION

I am going to stop this conversation now. We can revisit it if..

Boundary scripts: family + faith



Keep the language aligned with your values and your actual safety.

A FAMILY EXPECTATION

I know this matters to you. My decision is...

A PRIVATE TOPIC

I am not discussing that. Please do not ask again.

A SPIRITUAL DISAGREEMENT

My faith is important to me. I will not accept shame or coercion as spiritual guidance.

A GATHERING OR TRADITION

I will attend for... / I will not attend this time / I will leave if...

Boundary scripts: work + digital life



Professional can still be clear.

WORKLOAD

Given my current priorities, I can complete A or B by the deadline. Which should take priority?

AFTER-HOURS CONTACT

I will respond during...

DIGITAL PRIVACY

Do not post, forward, or share information about me without asking.

REPEATED MESSAGES

I have seen your message. More messages will not change my response time.

The guilt after a boundary



Guilt can appear when you break an old rule. It is not automatic proof that the boundary was wrong.

WHAT I SAID OR DID

The boundary in plain language.

WHAT GUILT PREDICTS

Rejection, anger, being misunderstood, punishment, loneliness, or being 'bad.'

WHAT THE BOUNDARY PROTECTS

Return to the need or value.

WHAT SUPPORT I NEED WHILE GUILT PASSES

Reassurance, no-contact time, distraction, grounding, a witness, or a plan.

Access is earned in layers



Someone can matter to you and still receive limited access.

PUBLIC ACCESS

What may acquaintances or the wider world know?

LIMITED ACCESS

What is shared only with consistency and respect?

TRUSTED ACCESS

What behaviors earn closeness over time?

NO ACCESS

What behavior leads you to step away or seek protection?

When a boundary is ignored



A repeated boundary without an action may become a request. Plan what you control.

THE BOUNDARY

What have you communicated?

HOW IT HAS BEEN TESTED OR IGNORED

Use dates, patterns, or examples if documentation is useful and safe.

MY NEXT ACTION

End call, leave, block, document, change logistics, involve support, or seek professional/legal guidance.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Finding my voice after freeze or fawn



You can return to a conversation later. A delayed response is still a response.

WHAT I COULD NOT SAY THEN

Write the sentence now.

WHAT MADE SPEAKING DIFFICULT

Power, surprise, safety, attachment, fatigue, history, or lack of words.

WHAT I CAN SAY NEXT

Try: I need to correct my earlier answer...

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Repair is not reconciliation



Repair requires accountability; reconciliation also requires consent and enough safety.

SIGNS OF REPAIR

- ☐ Names the behavior
- ☐ Listens to impact
- ☐ Changes over time
- ☐ Accepts consequences
- ☐ Respects your choice

NOT THE SAME AS REPAIR

- ☐ An apology with excuses
- ☐ Pressure to forgive
- ☐ Temporary charm
- ☐ Using intent to erase impact
- ☐ Demanding restored access

WHAT REPAIR WOULD REQUIRE HERE

You may decide that repair is insufficient or that reconciliation is not right for you.

My body is allowed to have limits



Body autonomy includes touch, proximity, medical care, sexuality, clothing, food, movement, rest, and sensory needs.

A BODY BOUNDARY I WANT RESPECTED

Specific is helpful; disclosure is optional.

MY EARLY WARNING SIGNALS

Tension, pulling away, numbness, nausea, heat, confusion, stillness, or another cue.

WORDS OR ACTIONS I CAN USE

No. Stop. Step back. Ask first. I need privacy. I am leaving.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Before a hard conversation



Prepare without rehearsing every possible outcome.

1

Write your one-sentence purpose: what do you need to communicate or decide?

2

Choose your limit: time, location, topic, witnesses, transportation, digital or in-person format.

3

Pick one sentence to repeat if the conversation circles or pressures you.

4

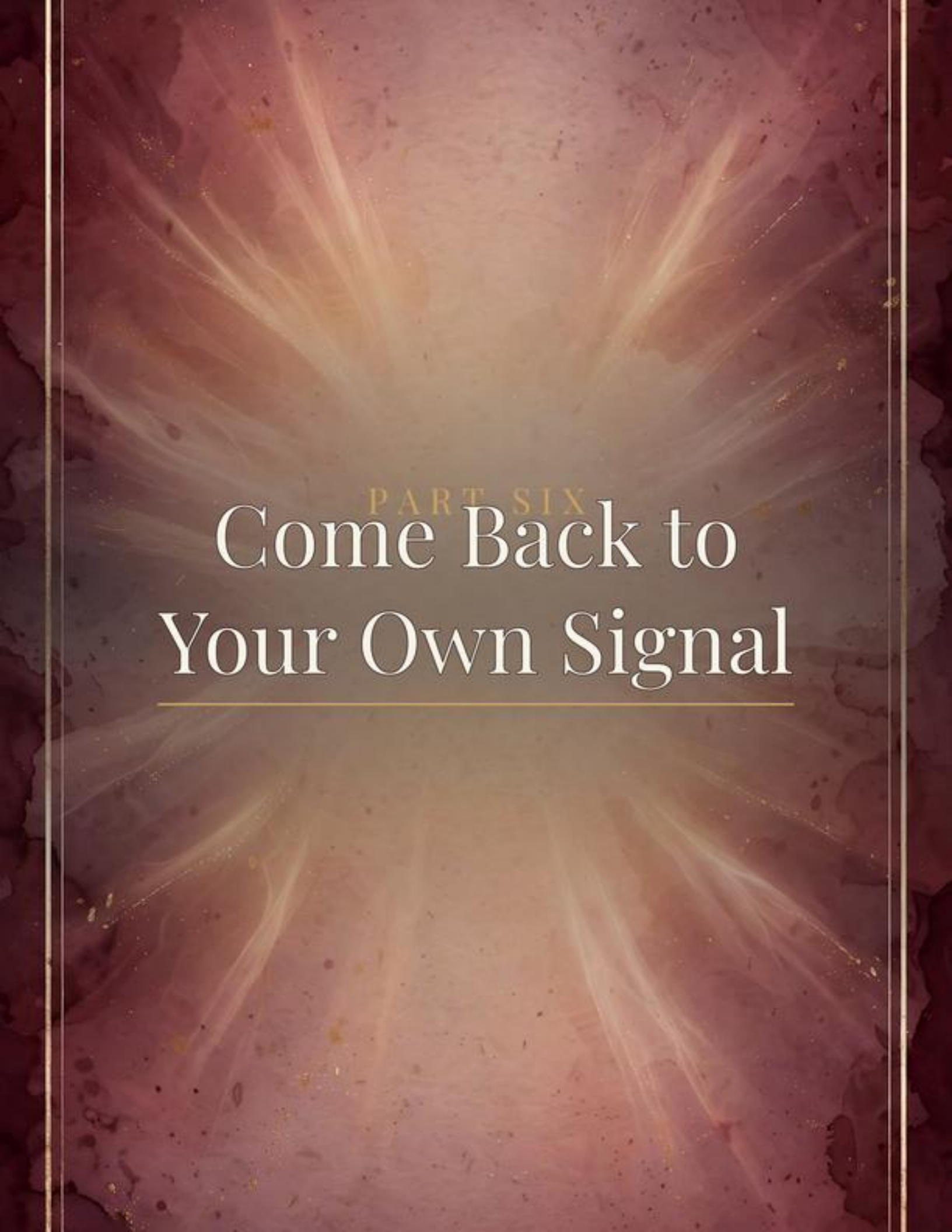
Plan an exit and an aftercare action. Keep your own transportation or support if relevant.

5

Orient to the room. Say: I can end a conversation that stops being constructive or safe.

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.



PART SIX

Come Back to Your Own Signal

My sensory profile



Notice what adds load and what reduces it. Preferences do not need a dramatic explanation.

SOUND + LIGHT

Volume, overlapping voices, hums, alarms, brightness, flicker, visual clutter.

TOUCH + CLOTHING + TEMPERATURE

Fabrics, pressure, tags, proximity, heat, cold, airflow.

SMELL + CROWDS + DEMANDS

Scents, motion, social density, interruptions, decisions, time pressure.

Early signs of overload



The earliest sign creates the widest choice point.

WHAT I NOTICE FIRST

Body, speech, attention, patience, movement, or decision-making.

WHAT OVERLOAD LOOKS LIKE LATER

Irritability, tears, shutdown, urgency, confusion, pain, escape, or numbness.

WHAT OTHERS MAY MISUNDERSTAND

What might look like rudeness, laziness, anger, or disinterest from the outside?

WHAT ACTUALLY HELPS

Reduce input, explain less, change environment, meet a body need, or get support.

Helpful input / unhelpful input



Build your own low-stimulation environment instead of copying someone else's.

LESS INPUT

- ☐ Lower or warmer light
- ☐ Reduce overlapping sound
- ☐ Loose or soft clothing
- ☐ Fewer words or decisions
- ☐ A predictable environment

SUPPORTIVE INPUT

- ☐ Steady music or rhythm
- ☐ Firm pressure if wanted
- ☐ Cool air or warm blanket
- ☐ Repetitive movement
- ☐ A calm familiar voice

MY LOW-STIMULATION RECIPE

List the setting, objects, words, and boundaries that help your system settle.

Capacity menu: two or ten minutes



Match the tool to the capacity you actually have.

ABOUT TWO MINUTES

- ☐ Lower light
- ☐ Reduce sound
- ☐ Loosen clothing
- ☐ Drink water
- ☐ Name the room

ABOUT TEN MINUTES

- ☐ Quiet shower
- ☐ Predictable music
- ☐ Gentle movement
- ☐ Blanket or fresh air
- ☐ Simple food

MY FASTEST RELIABLE RESET

What is available at home, work, in transit, and in public?

Capacity menu: thirty minutes / nothing left

When capacity is gone, reduce demands before adding self-improvement tasks.

ABOUT THIRTY MINUTES

- ☐ Low-input room
- ☐ Walk or repetitive motion
- ☐ Nourishing food
- ☐ Creative activity
- ☐ Supportive contact

WHEN NOTHING IS LEFT

- ☐ Stop optional demands
- ☐ Meet basic needs
- ☐ Send one brief update
- ☐ Ask for practical help
- ☐ Rest without debriefing

MY MINIMUM-CARE PLAN

What are the few basics that matter most when you cannot do the whole routine?

Decompression after work or caregiving



Transition time is a need, not a moral failure.

WHAT I AM CARRYING IN

Noise, decisions, touch, urgency, performance, conflict, responsibility.

WHAT SHOULD WAIT

Questions, chores, conversation, news, notifications, or decisions.

MY TRANSITION RITUAL

Length, environment, communication, food, clothing, movement, quiet, or prayer.

After conflict or a trigger



Regulate first when possible; analyze when more of you is available.

WHAT IS HAPPENING NOW

Current facts, not every possible meaning.

WHAT MY BODY NEEDS

Space, water, movement, medication as prescribed, food, warmth, coolness, or sleep.

WHAT DECISION CAN WAIT

Name what does not require an immediate answer.

WHAT SUPPORT WOULD BE USEFUL

Listening, advice, company, a ride, childcare, professional help, or privacy.

Five-senses orientation



An external-focus practice for returning attention to the present.

1

Name five things you see. Choose ordinary details: edges, colors, shadows, lettering.

2

Name four points of contact or textures. You can touch objects instead of focusing inside your body.

3

Name three sounds, including quiet or distant sounds.

4

Name two scents - or two scents you remember as neutral or pleasant.

5

Name one taste, sip of water, or fact about the present: I am in... It is...

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.

Feet-on-floor reset



No breath counting and no requirement to relax.

1

Place or notice your feet on a stable surface. Adjust until the position is tolerable.

2

Press down gently for three seconds, then release. Notice the difference without judging it.

3

Look left, center, and right. Name one neutral object in each direction.

4

Push your hands together or against a wall if pressure feels supportive.

5

Ask: What is the next concrete thing - not the whole future?

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.

Optional slow-breath practice



Skip this if breath focus increases discomfort. External orientation works too.

1

Choose a natural breath. Do not hold it. Let your eyes stay open if you prefer.

2

If comfortable, allow the exhale to become slightly longer than the inhale. No exact count is required.

3

Repeat only a few times. Stop at the first sign it feels worse or forced.

4

Return to ordinary breathing and notice the room, your feet, or a steady object.

5

Name one choice you have right now: stop, continue, move, drink, call, rest.

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.

Intuition, fear, and information



You do not have to perfectly separate them before making a safer choice.

WHAT MY SIGNAL SAYS

The first clear sentence, sensation, concern, or preference.

WHAT FACTS I HAVE

Observable evidence, history, timing, and missing information.

WHAT FEAR PREDICTS

Name the feared outcome without treating it as certainty.

THE SMALLEST PROTECTIVE NEXT STEP

Pause, ask, verify, delay, leave, consult, document, or choose.

A decision I can live with



Self-trust does not require a guarantee. It requires a process you respect.

THE DECISION

State it in one sentence.

MY VALUES AND NON-NEGOTIABLES

What matters more than pleasing, proving, or rushing?

WHAT I KNOW / ASSUME / NEED TO LEARN

Separate the three.

MY NEXT REVIEW POINT

When will you reassess rather than ruminate continuously?

Promises that build trust



Make the promise small, observable, and responsive to real capacity.

THE PROMISE

Something within your control.

WHY IT MATTERS

What value or need does it serve?

THE MINIMUM VERSION

What counts on a difficult day?

IF I MISS IT

How will I repair without abandonment or punishment?

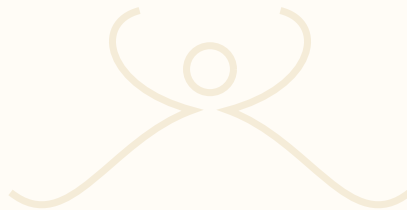
Draw your inner weather



Use a forecast, sky map, symbols, colors, pressure systems, temperatures, or absurd weather icons.

MAKE IT YOURS

Add what is passing, what is settled in, what needs shelter, and one patch of possibility. Weather changes; no feeling has to become your identity.



PART SEVEN

Love With Room to Breathe

What safety looks like in connection



Safety is a pattern over time, not one perfect moment.

GREEN SIGNALS

- ☐ Respects no
- ☐ Words match behavior
- ☐ Can repair
- ☐ Makes room for difference
- ☐ Does not punish honesty

YELLOW SIGNALS

- ☐ Inconsistency
- ☐ Pressure disguised as care
- ☐ Avoids accountability
- ☐ Rushes closeness
- ☐ Leaves you chronically confused

MY RED SIGNALS

Name behaviors that require distance, support, documentation, or a safety plan.

How I know I am safe enough

Look for what happens in your body, choices, voice, and daily life.



I CAN

Disagree, rest, say no, make mistakes, have other relationships, change my mind...

I DO NOT HAVE TO

Perform, monitor every mood, prove loyalty, surrender privacy, explain every feeling...

WHEN HARM HAPPENS

What repair, accountability, and changed behavior look like.

The closeness pattern



Notice the sequence without turning an attachment idea into a fixed identity.

WHEN CLOSENESS INCREASES

What feelings, thoughts, urges, or behaviors appear?

WHEN DISTANCE APPEARS

What do you assume, pursue, avoid, test, or protect?

WHAT SECURE-ENOUGH CONNECTION WOULD INCLUDE

Consistency, autonomy, reassurance, boundaries, repair, pacing.

Receiving care



Receiving can feel vulnerable when giving, achieving, or needing less once felt safer.

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN SOMEONE HELPS ME

Relief, debt, suspicion, gratitude, discomfort, loss of control, urge to repay.

WHAT MAKES CARE EASIER TO RECEIVE

Specific offers, choice, privacy, no strings, predictability, or time.

A SMALL FORM OF CARE I CAN ACCEPT

Choose something consent-based and low stakes.

Reciprocity check



Relationships do not need perfect equality in every moment, but the pattern should not require one person to vanish.

WHAT I GIVE

Attention, labor, money, flexibility, emotional care, repair, celebration, honesty.

WHAT I RECEIVE

Include forms different from how you naturally give.

WHAT NEEDS CONVERSATION OR CHANGE

Be concrete about the imbalance and your request or boundary.

Conflict without catastrophe



Disagreement can be uncomfortable without becoming abandonment, coercion, or harm.

WHAT CONFLICT ACTIVATES IN ME

Fear, urgency, numbness, proving, appeasing, leaving, or fixing.

WHAT HELPS ME STAY PRESENT

Time limits, breaks, writing, lower volume, one topic, neutral place, support.

WHAT I NEED FROM THE OTHER PERSON

Listening, accountability, clarity, respect, pacing, or a changed behavior.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Repair conversation

Repair is specific. It does not require either person to surrender reality.



WHAT HAPPENED

When...

THE IMPACT

The effect on me / us was...

MY RESPONSIBILITY

The part I own is...

WHAT REPAIR ASKS

Going forward, I need / will...

When love and distance coexist



Distance may be temporary, permanent, practical, emotional, digital, or topic-specific.

WHAT I LOVE OR VALUE

Honesty does not require erasing complexity.

WHY DISTANCE MAY BE NEEDED

Safety, stability, sobriety, healing, boundaries, repeated harm, or capacity.

WHAT KIND OF DISTANCE

Define contact, channels, frequency, topics, intermediaries, or no contact.

SOFT LANDING

Activation 0-10

☐ continue

☐ pause

☐ stop

☐ reach out

Right now my body needs:

Next kind action:

Chosen family and trusted community



Belonging can be built through people who practice care, not only people linked by blood or history.

WHO HELPS ME FEEL MORE LIKE MYSELF

Names, groups, communities, elders, peers, mentors, or spiritual homes.

WHAT WE PRACTICE TOGETHER

Mutuality, laughter, truth, ritual, accountability, rest, creativity, service.

HOW I WANT TO PARTICIPATE

Receiving, initiating, showing up, setting limits, celebrating, asking.

My support circle



Different people can hold different roles. No one person must meet every need.

FOR LISTENING

Who can hear without fixing or minimizing?

FOR PRACTICAL HELP

Rides, meals, childcare, errands, logistics, professional knowledge.

FOR JOY AND ORDINARY LIFE

Who helps you laugh, play, create, worship, move, or rest?

FOR PROFESSIONAL SUPPORT

Therapist, doctor, advocate, peer specialist, clergy, coach within scope.

After a hard interaction

Return to yourself before deciding what the interaction means.



1

Move to a safer or more private setting if needed. Notice the date, place, and current level of safety.

2

Meet one physical need before analyzing: water, food, medication as prescribed, bathroom, warmth, coolness, rest.

3

Write three columns: what happened / what I assume / what I need to know.

4

Decide whether a response is needed now, later, through another person, or not at all.

5

Choose support and aftercare. If the interaction involved abuse or danger, use a qualified advocate or safety resource.

CHOICE IS PART OF THE PRACTICE

Eyes may stay open. Change position, skip a step, shorten the practice, or stop. If inward focus feels worse, name neutral objects in the room instead.

PART EIGHT

Come back to you

Joy does not erase what happened. It reminds you that what happened does not own every part of you.

INSIDE THIS PART

- Play without performance
- Sensory favorites and small adventures
- Doodles, symbols, soundtracks, and color
- Permission to be delightfully bad at things
- Celebrating the life already happening

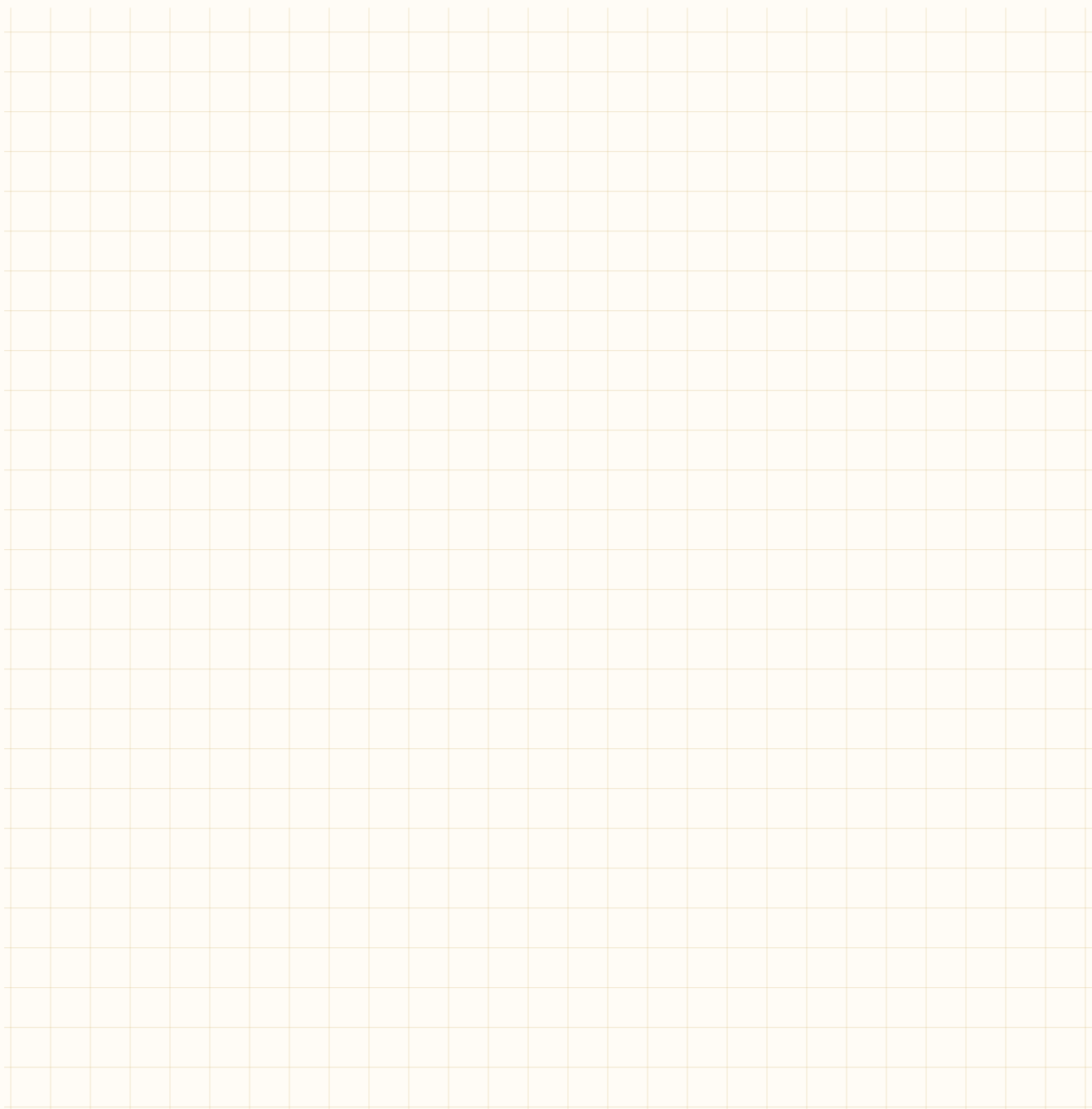
My joy map



Place yourself in the center. Add people, places, objects, sounds, foods, movements, ideas, memories, and tiny experiences that create aliveness.

MAKE IT YOURS

Use roads for easy access, bridges for support, mountains for barriers, and stars for joys you want to rediscover.



What makes me feel like me



Look beyond productivity and other people's expectations.

I FEEL MOST LIKE MYSELF WHEN

Moments, environments, clothes, topics, people, movement, solitude.

I LOSE TRACK OF TIME WHEN

Curiosity is useful data.

I WANT MORE ROOM FOR

A quality, interest, identity, practice, or kind of day.

My sensory favorites



Pleasure can be quiet, specific, and ordinary.

COMFORTING

- ☐ A texture
- ☐ A scent
- ☐ A temperature
- ☐ A sound
- ☐ A familiar taste

ENERGIZING

- ☐ A color
- ☐ A rhythm
- ☐ A movement
- ☐ A place
- ☐ A surprising flavor

A FIVE-SENSE JOY I CAN PLAN

Design one small moment using what you actually like.

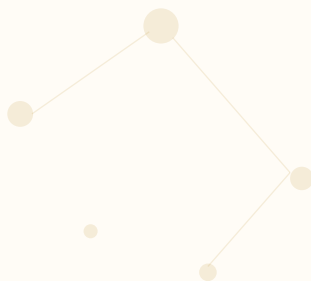
My personal constellation



Draw yourself as a star or symbol. Add the people, values, memories, skills, places, and dreams that help you navigate.

MAKE IT YOURS

Connections can be near, far, bright, faint, new, or remembered. You decide what belongs in your sky.



Things I am allowed to be bad at



Skill is not the price of participation.

SOMETHING I WANT TO TRY BADLY

Art, dance, gardening, games, language, music, baking, sports, making, singing.

WHAT PERFECTION WOULD STEAL

Spontaneity, learning, laughter, community, experimentation, rest.

MY DELIBERATELY IMPERFECT PLAN

When and how will you try without turning it into a performance?

Tiny-adventure bingo



Fill the grid with small adventures: a new snack, a different route, a library aisle, a sunrise, a thrift-store treasure, a dance break, a free event, a blanket fort.

MAKE IT YOURS

Keep the squares cheap, accessible, and varied in energy. The center square can be 'change my mind.'

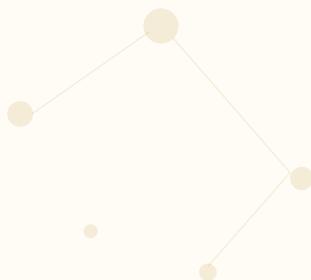
The soundtrack of me



Create album covers, a track list, eras, genres, or songs for courage, grief, softness, confidence, play, faith, rest, and becoming.

MAKE IT YOURS

Use song titles only; do not copy lyrics. Add a bonus track for the version of you arriving next.



Include one ridiculous luxury and one practical boundary. No budget or physics required.

Small celebrations



Celebration can mark effort, survival, repair, consistency, rest, delight, and ordinary life.

SOMETHING WORTH NOTICING

It does not have to impress anyone.

HOW I WANT TO MARK IT

Food, music, outfit, photo, prayer, walk, call, candle, nap, sticker, private ritual.

WHO GETS ACCESS TO THIS JOY

Private, shared, community, or carefully chosen people.

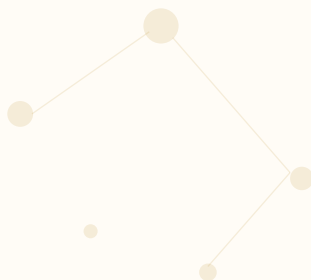
Permission slips

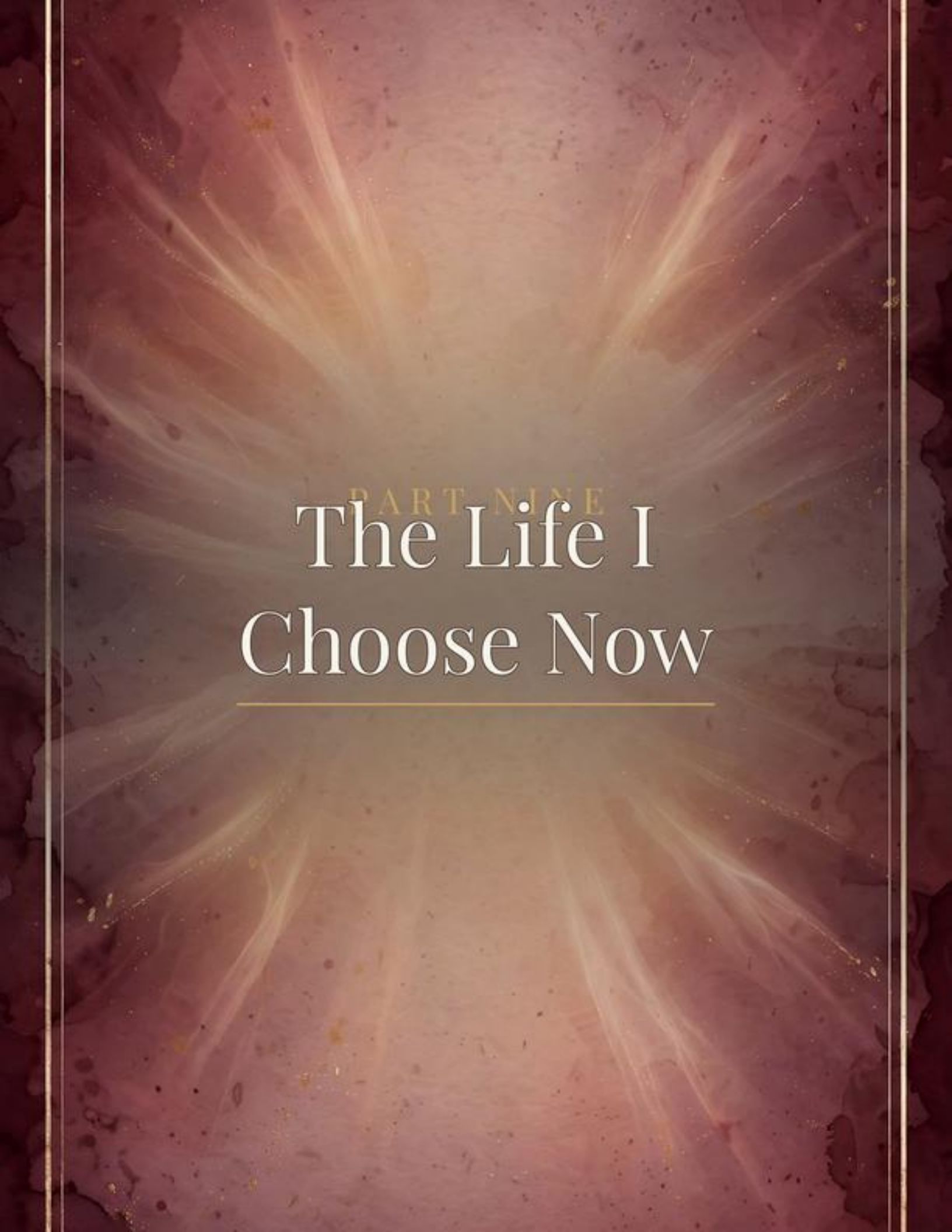


Write, draw, or type permission slips for rest, pleasure, changing your mind, taking up space, trying badly, asking, receiving, dressing for yourself, or doing nothing useful.

MAKE IT YOURS

Sign them as the present-day authority in your own life. Add an expiration date of 'not required.'





PART NINE

The Life I Choose Now

Values I want to live



Choose values that guide behavior, not words that pressure you to perform.

THE VALUES

Examples: honesty, tenderness, justice, faith, curiosity, steadiness, freedom, community.

WHAT THEY LOOK LIKE ON AN ORDINARY DAY

Translate each value into a small action or boundary.

WHAT THEY DO NOT REQUIRE

Perfection, exhaustion, access for everyone, constant certainty, or self-abandonment.

The future I am making room for



Let the future be specific enough to feel, flexible enough to breathe.

HOW I WANT MY DAYS TO FEEL

Choose qualities before achievements.

WHAT I WANT AROUND ME

People, environments, routines, beauty, work, faith, learning, quiet, play.

WHAT I AM NO LONGER ORGANIZING MY LIFE AROUND

Fear, proving, secrecy, urgency, another person's moods, or an old role.

How I will recognize growth



Growth may look like earlier noticing, clearer choices, kinder repair, more support, or shorter recovery - not never struggling.

SIGNS I AM CHANGING

Use evidence from daily life.

WHAT STILL FEELS HARD

Difficulty does not erase movement.

HOW I WANT TO RESPOND WHEN I SLIP

No abandonment. What does repair with yourself look like?

Finding the right support



A provider should respect your autonomy, identities, culture, faith, goals, and boundaries.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ASK

Are you licensed, and in what discipline? What experience do you have with my concerns? How do you approach trauma without forcing disclosure? How do you handle goals, feedback, culture, faith, accessibility, cost, insurance, and crisis planning?

WHAT I WANT HELP WITH

You do not need a perfect label. Describe what is affecting daily life.

WHAT HELPS ME FEEL RESPECTED

Communication style, identities, privacy, pacing, accommodations, spiritual integration or separation.

PRACTICAL NEEDS

Location, telehealth, schedule, cost, insurance, language, accessibility, childcare, transportation.

Support beyond the page



Verified U.S. national resources as of September 2026. If outside the U.S., add local services below.

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline

Call or text 988; chat at 988lifeline.org. Free, confidential support 24/7/365.

National Domestic Violence Hotline

Call 800-799-SAFE (7233); text START to 88788; chat at TheHotline.org.

RAINN National Sexual Assault Hotline

Call 800-656-HOPE (4673); text HOPE to 64673; chat at RAINN.org.

SAMHSA National Helpline + treatment locator

Call 800-662-HELP (4357) or search FindTreatment.gov.

DIGITAL SAFETY

If someone monitors your device, browsing history, phone records, accounts, or location, use a safer device when possible and ask an advocate about technology safety. Clearing history may not remove every record.

MY LOCAL OR INTERNATIONAL RESOURCES

Include emergency, crisis, advocacy, healthcare, community, and faith resources that fit your location.

You are allowed to pause. You are allowed to choose. You are allowed to become.

This journal is educational and reflective. It is not medical care, diagnosis, therapy, legal advice, or emergency service.